

LOW CODE DEVELOPMENT

EXPERIMENT - 2

Setting up a Zoho Creator Account and Exploring the Platform Architecture and Interface

1. Aim

To set up a Zoho Creator account, create a sample application containing a form, report and dashboard, and to explore the Develop, Deploy and Manage sections of the Zoho Creator platform architecture and interface.

2. Setting up Zoho Creator

I. Create the Sample Application

Procedure:

- Logged in to Zoho Creator using the organization account.
- Navigated to the Applications section under the Develop menu.
- Clicked on Create Application and selected From Scratch.
- Created two sample applications — "Corporate Assets" and "My first Creator app" — inside the organization workspace "durkasri.sm.2024.cse_raja533".
- Each application was successfully created and listed on the Applications dashboard.

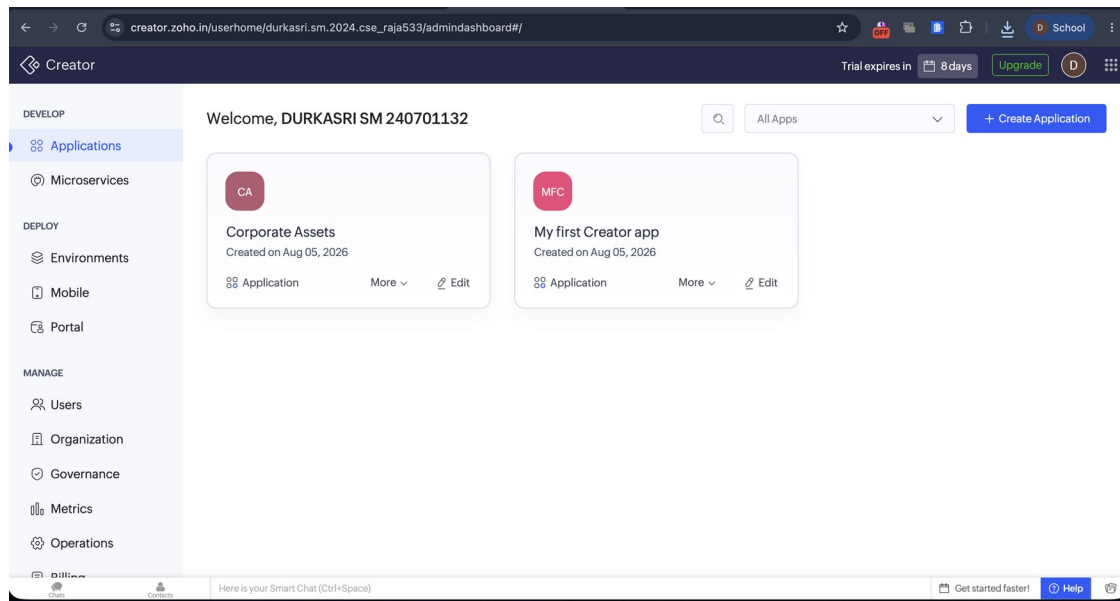


Fig 2.1 — Applications dashboard showing the sample applications created (Corporate Assets and My first Creator app).

II. Creating Form, Report and Dashboard

Procedure:

- Opened the sample application and selected Create → Form to design an input form with the required fields.

- Used Create → Report to generate a report linked to the form, allowing records to be viewed, sorted and filtered.
- Used Create → Dashboard to add report and chart components for a graphical summary of the application data.
- Saved the form, report and dashboard within the application so that they appear together under the Application view.

Explanation:

A Form is used to collect information from users through input fields; the data entered is stored in the application's database. A Report displays the records submitted through the form and lets users search, sort and filter the stored data. A Dashboard presents a graphical, at-a-glance overview of the application by combining reports and charts on a single page, making the data easier to analyse. Together, the form, report and dashboard make up the core building blocks of any Zoho Creator application, as seen in the sample applications created above.

3. Exploring the Platform Architecture and Interface

The Zoho Creator console is organized into three main sections — Develop, Deploy and Manage — visible on the left navigation panel of the Admin Dashboard.

Develop

- The Develop section is used to build applications and microservices.
- It allows users to create forms, reports, pages and workflows for each application.
- It also supports application customization using Deluge scripting and low-code tools.

Deploy

- The Deploy section is used to move and publish applications across environments.
- It provides Stage and Production environments to test an application before it goes live, along with Mobile and Portal deployment options.
- User roles and permissions for the deployed application can also be configured here.

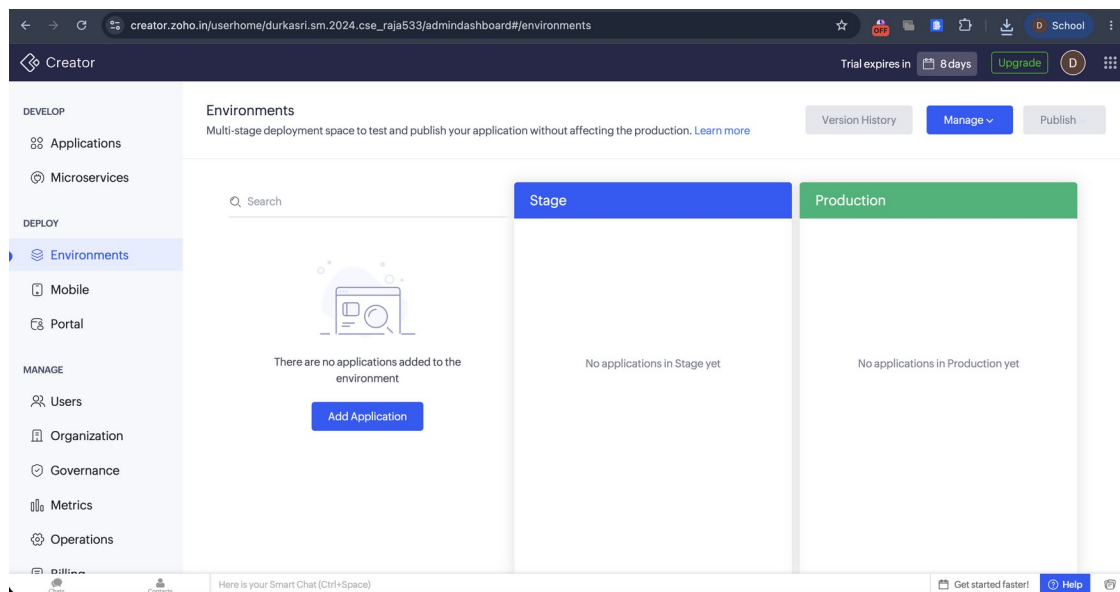


Fig 3.1 — Environments page under Deploy, showing the Stage and Production spaces used for multi-stage deployment.

Manage

- The Manage section is used to administer the organization and its applications.
- It helps manage Users, Organization details, Governance policies, Metrics and Operations such as backups and integrations.
- It also monitors application performance and enforces account security and access control.

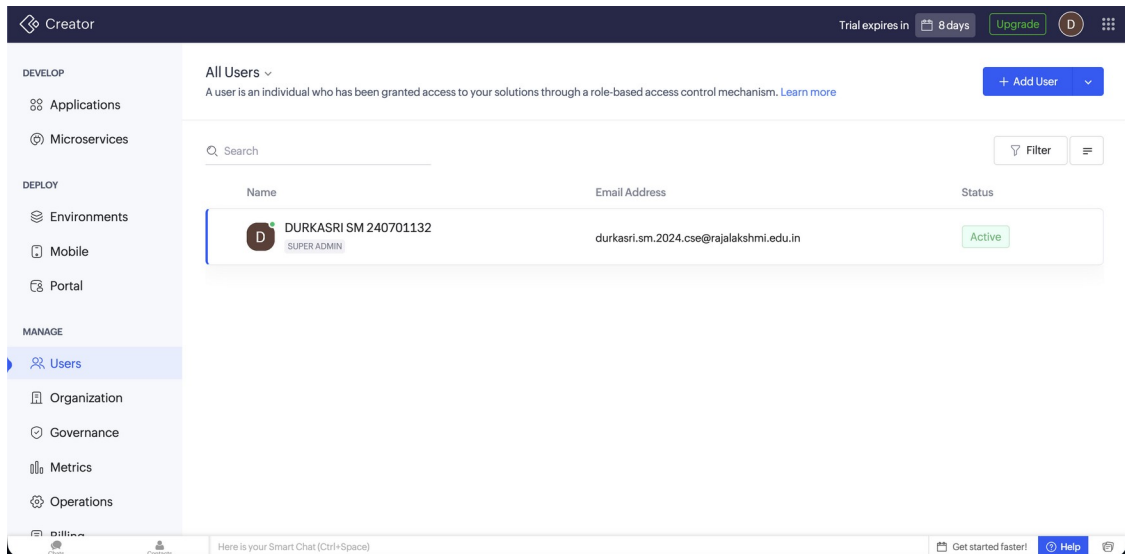


Fig 3.2 — Users page under Manage, listing the account holder with the Super Admin role and Active status.

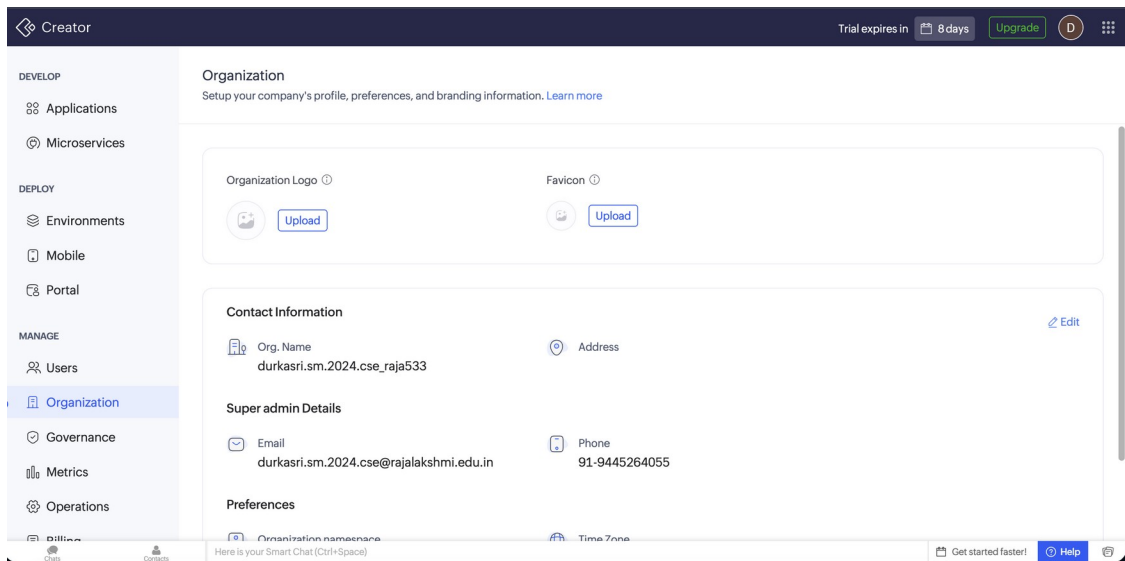


Fig 3.3 — Organization page under Manage, displaying organization name, super admin contact details and preferences.

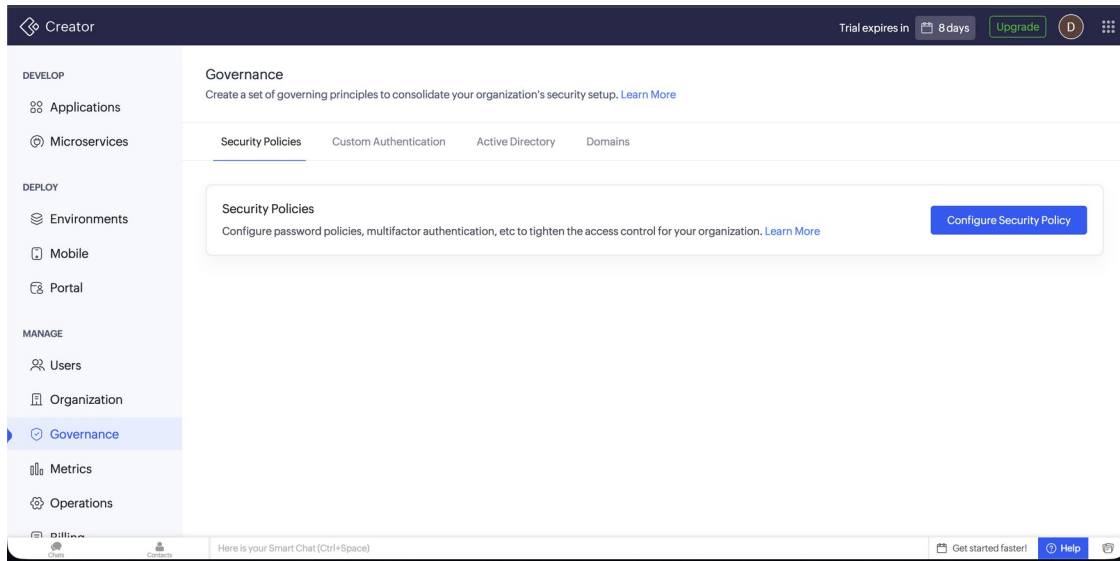


Fig 3.4 — Governance page under Manage, used to configure Security Policies, Custom Authentication, Active Directory and Domains.

4. Result

Thus, a Zoho Creator account was set up successfully. A sample application with a form, report and dashboard was created, and the Develop, Deploy and Manage sections of the Zoho Creator platform architecture and interface were explored successfully.